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# Deputy Director Insights, Data Science, Economics and Analysis (IDEA Unit)

Government Digital Service

**Apply before 11:55 pm on Thursday 12th November 2026**

Government Digital Service

**Reference number**

488581

**Salary**

£86,000

£86,000 + benefits. Non civil servants will be expected to start at the salary minimum if successful. Existing Civil Servants will be appointed in

line with the Civil Service pay rules. If you are applying from another Government Department on a lateral move we will match your base salary

**Job grade**

SCS Pay Band 1

**Contract type**

Permanent

**Business area**

Idea Unit

**Type of role**

Digital
Information Technology

**Working pattern**

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time, Compressed hours

**Number of jobs available**

1

## Contents


Location
About the job
Benefits
Things you need to know
Apply and further information


## Location

Bristol, London, Manchester

# About the job

**Job summary**

The Government Digital Service (GDS) is the digital centre of government. We are responsible for setting, leading and delivering the vision for a modern digital government.

Our priorities are to drive a modern digital government, by:

1. joining up public sector services
2. harnessing the power of AI for the public good
3. strengthening and extending our digital and data public infrastructure
4. elevating leadership and investing in talent
5. funding for outcomes and procuring for growth and innovation
6. committing to transparency and driving accountability

We are home to the Incubator for Artificial Intelligence (I.AI), the world-leading GOV.UK and at the forefront of coordinating the UK s geospatial strategy and activity. We lead the Government Digital and Data function and champion the work of digital teams across government.

We re part of the Department for Science, Innovation and Technology (DSIT) and employ more than 1,000 people all over the UK, with hubs in Manchester, London and Bristol.

The Government Digital Service is where talent translates into impact. From your first day, you ll be working with some of the world s most highly-skilled digital professionals, all contributing their knowledge to make change on a national scale.

Join us for rewarding work that makes a difference across the UK. You'll solve some of the nation s highest-priority digital challenges, helping millions of people access services they need

As Deputy Director, you ll lead the Government Digital Service s IDEA Unit a high-performing, cross-disciplinary analytical capability at the heart of government s digital and data reform agenda.

You ll provide strategic leadership for a team of analysts, economists, data scientists and researchers who deliver the insight, evaluation and evidence base behind some of the UK Government s most ambitious programmes, including One Login, the National Data Library, AI adoption, service transformation and system reform. You ll also build internal automation and AI solutions that help the organisation deliver.

**Job description**

**Former DSIT recruitment campaigns are continuing as usual, but candidates should be aware that following the Government s announcement on the changes to some civil service departments, roles will be subject to the machinery of government moves and will ultimately be in one of the new departments. We will provide more information if you are selected for a role. This work remains of high importance to the civil service, and we thank you for your continued interest.**

This is a system leadership role. You ll champion the use of data and evidence across GDS and government, making sure decision-makers have the insight and confidence to invest in transformative programmes that deliver better services and outcomes for citizens.

As Deputy Director, you ll:

- provide collective leadership as part of GDS s Senior Leadership Team, shaping strategy and direction and making sure IDEA s work supports organisational priorities and government reform goals
- lead and inspire the IDEA Unit, creating an inclusive, high-performing culture across a multidisciplinary team of economists, analysts, researchers and data scientists
- set the strategic vision for analysis and evidence in GDS, making sure outputs are high quality, timely and influential with senior decision-makers across Whitehall

oversee economic analysis and evaluation of major programmes, including One Login, the National Data Library and AI adoption, ensuring value for money, reduced risk and strong funding cases

champion data science, automation and AI solutions that drive efficiency, productivity and innovation across GDS operations and government services

ensure robust data infrastructure and governance, including pipelines, dashboards and performance frameworks that underpin strategic decision-making

act as Senior Responsible Owner (SRO) for major analytical programmes, such as the Digital Dashboard, the Data and Analytics Strategy or cross-government workforce insights

represent and connect the system, building partnerships with senior leaders in government, academia and industry and shaping thought leadership in digital, data and AI

develop talent and capability, building a sustainable pipeline of analytical leaders and embedding professional standards across the 4 analytical professions

**Person specification**

We  re interested in people who:

have proven system leadership across multiple analytical disciplines, overseeing and enabling work spanning economics, data analytics and AI or data engineering, and making sure each discipline is used to maximum effect in large, complex programmes

bring strategic vision and thought leadership, with the ability to set direction, champion innovation and act as an authoritative voice on the role of data, economics and AI in transforming government services and delivery

are inspiring people leaders, with a track record of leading diverse, high-performing teams across disciplines, creating inclusive and collaborative cultures and investing in professional development and future talent pipelines

have delivered impactful analytical programmes at scale, leading analysis, modelling or evaluation that has informed senior decision-making, funding and strategy in a complex policy or operational delivery context

- communicate and influence with impact, explaining complex analytical and technical insights to Ministers, senior officials and non-technical audiences, shaping debate and securing buy-in at the highest levels
- have credibility in at least one analytical profession, or equivalent applied experience, with the confidence and authority to lead, inspire and challenge across other disciplines such as economics, data science and AI engineering

## Benefits

There are many benefits of working at GDS, including:

- flexible hybrid working with flexi-time and the option to work part-time or condensed hours
- a Civil Service Pension with an average employer contribution of 28.97%
- 25 days of annual leave, increasing by a day each year up to a maximum of 30 days
- an extra day off for the King  s birthday
- an in-year bonus scheme to recognise high performance
- career progression and coaching, including a training budget for personal development
- a focus on wellbeing with access to an employee assistance programme
- job satisfaction from making government services easier to use and more inclusive for people across the UK
- advances on pay, including for travel season tickets
- death in service benefits
- cycle to work scheme and facilities
- access to an employee discounts scheme
- 10 learning days per year
- volunteering opportunities (5 special leave days per year)
- access to a suite of learning activities through Civil Service learning

Any move to Government Digital Service from another employer will mean you can no longer access childcare vouchers. This includes moves between government departments. You may however be eligible for other government schemes, including Tax Free Childcare. Determine your eligibility at https://www.childcarechoices.gov.uk

**Office attendance**
The Department operates a discretionary hybrid working policy, which provides for a combination of working hours from your place of work and from your home in the UK. The current expectation for staff is to attend the office or non-home based location for 40-60% of the time over the accounting period.
DSIT does not normally offer full home working (i.e. working at home); but we do offer a variety of flexible working options (including occasionally working from home).

## Things you need to know

**Artificial intelligence**

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our candidate guidance (opens in a new window) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

**Selection process details**

The standard selection process for roles at GDS consists of:

- a simple application screening process - We only ask for a CV and cover letter of up to 500 words. Important tip - please ensure that your cover letter includes how you meet the skills and experience listed in the person specification section above

a 60 minute video interview. As part of the interview process there will be a presentation task to be prepared and presented during the interview. Details around the presentation task will be shared with shortlisted candidates

Depending on how many applications we get, there might also be an extra stage before the video interview, for example a phone interview or a technical exercise.

In the event we receive a high volume of applications, we will conduct the initial sift against the lead criteria which is:

have proven system leadership across multiple analytical disciplines, overseeing and enabling work spanning economics, data analytics and AI or data engineering, and making sure each discipline is used to maximum effect in large, complex programmes

In the Civil Service, we use Success Profiles to evaluate your skills and ability. This gives us the best possible chance of finding the right person for the job, increases performance and improves diversity and inclusivity. We ll be assessing your technical abilities, skills, experience and behaviours that are relevant to this role.

For this role we ll be assessing you against the following Civil Service Behaviours:

leadership

making effective decisions

working together

**Recruitment Timeline**

Sift completion: week commencing Monday 16th November 2026

Panel interviews: week commencing Monday 23rd November 2026

Candidates that do not pass the interview but have demonstrated an acceptable standard may be considered for similar roles at a lower grade.

A reserve list will be held for a period of 12 months, from which further appointments can be made.

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan and the Civil Service D&I Strategy.

Please note that this role requires SC clearance, which would normally need 5 years UK residency in the past 5 years. This is not an absolute requirement, but supplementary checks may be needed where individuals have not lived in the UK for that period. This may mean your security clearance (and therefore your appointment) will take longer or, in some cases, not be possible.

For meaningful checks to be carried out, you will need to have lived in the UK for a sufficient period of time, to enable appropriate checks to be carried out and produce a result which provides the required level of assurance. Whilst a lack of UK residency in itself is not necessarily a bar to a security clearance, and expectation of UK residency may range from 3 to 5 years. Failure to meet the residency requirements needed for the role may result in the withdrawal of provisional jobs offers.

**Sponsorship**

DSIT cannot offer Visa sponsorship to candidates through this campaign. DSIT holds a Visa sponsorship licence but this can only be used for certain roles and this campaign does not qualify.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

This role has a minimum assignment duration of 3 years. An assignment duration is the period of time a Senior Civil Servant is expected to remain in the same post to enable them to deliver on the agreed key business outcomes. The assignment duration also supports your career through building your depth of expertise.

As part of accepting this role you will be agreeing to the expected assignment duration set out above. This will not result in a contractual change to your terms and conditions. Please note this is an expectation only, it is not something which is written into your terms and conditions or indeed which

the employing organisation or you are bound by. It will depend on your personal circumstances at a particular time and business needs, for example, would not preclude any absence like family friendly leave. It is nonetheless an important expectation, which is why we ask you to confirm you agree to the assignment duration set out above.

**Security**

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check (opens in a new window).

See our vetting charter (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete baseline personnel security standard (opens in new window) checks.

**Nationality requirements**

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

- UK nationals
- nationals of the Republic of Ireland
- nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS) (opens in a new window)
- nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)
- individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020
- Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

Further information on nationality requirements (opens in a new window)

**Working for the Civil Service**

The Civil Service Code (opens in a new window) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's recruitment principles (opens in a new window).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

The Civil Service also offers a Redeployment Interview Scheme to civil servants who are at risk of redundancy, and who meet the minimum requirements for the advertised vacancy.

**Diversity and Inclusion**

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the Civil Service People Plan (opens in a new window) and the Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy (opens in a new window).

## Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the Great Place to Work for Veterans (opens in a new window) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. Read more about prison leaver recruitment (opens in new window).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

**Contact point for applicants**

Job contact :

Name : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

Recruitment team

Email : gdsrecruitment@dsit.gov.uk

**Further information**

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, you should contact gds-complaints@dsit.gov.uk in the first instance.

If you are not satisfied with the response you receive you can contact the Civil Service Commission by email: info@csc.gov.uk Or in writing: Civil Service Commission, Room G/8 1 Horse Guards Road, London, SW1A 2HQ.

Civil Service Commission

disability confident EMPLOYER